



Procedure- Suspending, withdrawing or reducing the scope of certification

- PURPOSE** This document describes the process and requirements for reducing the scope of certification, suspending, withdrawing certification in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1 and applicable certification requirements.
- SCOPE:** This document applies to all ARPL QMS certification activities involving the reduction of certification scope, suspension, restoration, and withdrawal of certification. It covers the evaluation, decision-making, communication, implementation, and maintenance of records associated with such actions.
- REFERENCES:** ISO/IEC 17021-1
- RESPONSIBILITY:** The Managing Director (MD) is responsible for implementing this process and monitoring its effectiveness and efficiency. Certificate Authority personnel are responsible for implementing the process within their respective certification programme(s) and ensuring that all applicable requirements are consistently followed.

5. DESCRIPTION:

For Suspension: BVSP shall consider suspension of certification when,

- The client's certified management system has persistently or seriously failed to meet certification requirements, including requirements relating to management-system effectiveness.
- The client does not permit required surveillance or recertification audits to be conducted at the required frequency.
- The client voluntarily requests suspension.
- The client fails to fulfil other applicable certification requirements.
- Other documented circumstances exist that justify temporary suspension of certification.

Suspension Process: When suspension is considered:

- The applicable evidence shall be reviewed by the Certification Authority.
- The basis for suspension shall be documented.
- An authorized certification decision shall be made.
- The client shall be formally notified of the suspension.
- The conditions required for restoration shall be clearly communicated.

During suspension, the client's management-system certification shall be considered temporarily invalid.

Withdrawal of Certification: Certification shall be withdrawn when

- The client fails to resolve the issues resulting in suspension within the established timeframe.
- The client voluntarily requests withdrawal.
- The client no longer fulfils applicable certification requirements.

Reduction of Scope of Certification:

The Certification Body shall reduce the scope of certification where the certified client has persistently or seriously failed to meet the applicable certification requirements for specific parts of the certified scope. The reduction shall exclude only those activities, products, services, processes, locations, or other applicable elements that do not

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meet the certification requirements and shall be consistent with the requirements of the applicable certification standard.

Process:

1. The CB shall review the relevant audit evidence and nonconformities.
2. The affected part of the certification scope shall be clearly identified.
3. The Certification Authority shall evaluate and make the scope-reduction decision.
4. The client shall be formally notified of the decision.
5. The certificate and certification records shall be revised accordingly.
6. Publicly available certification information shall be updated, where applicable.
7. The client shall cease making certification claims for the excluded part of the scope.

6.0 Record

Record	Responsibility	Retention Period
BVSPL-A-22- Data Base of Certificates Issued and Withdrawn	QM/TM	3 Years

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